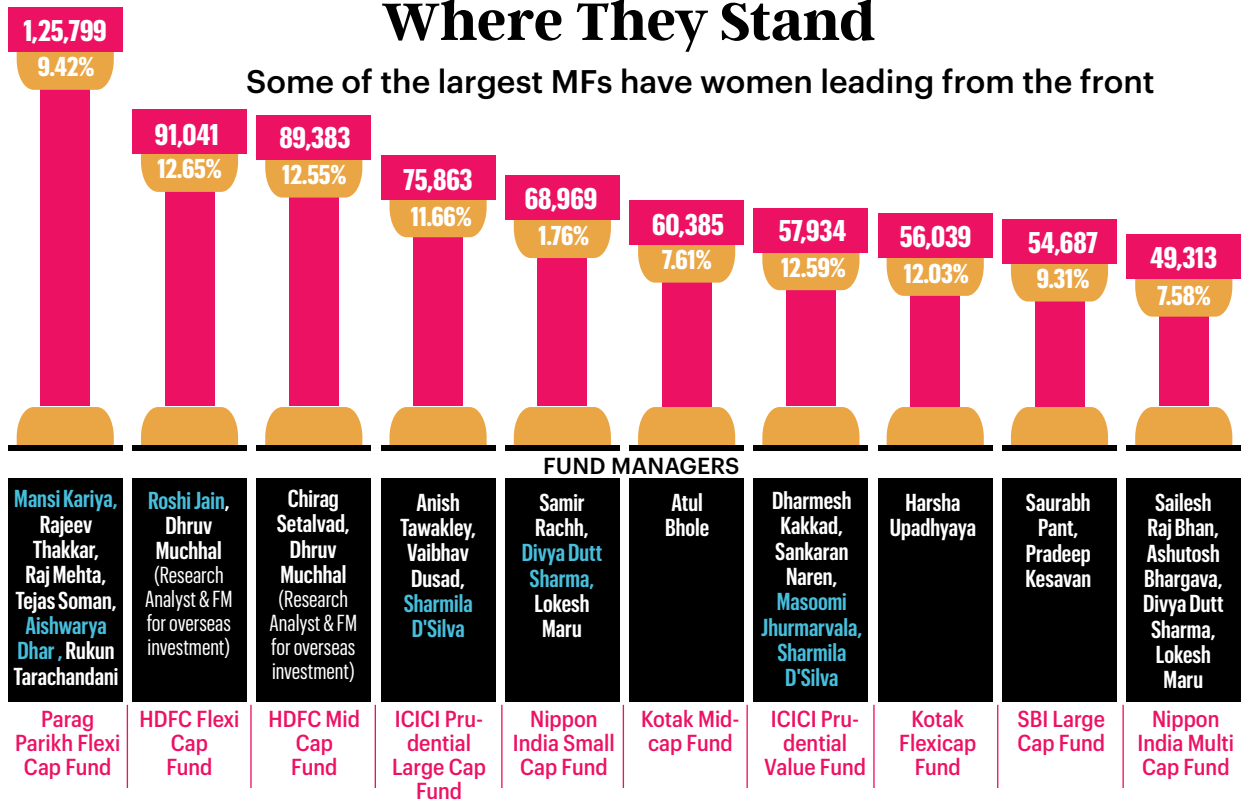


Where They Stand

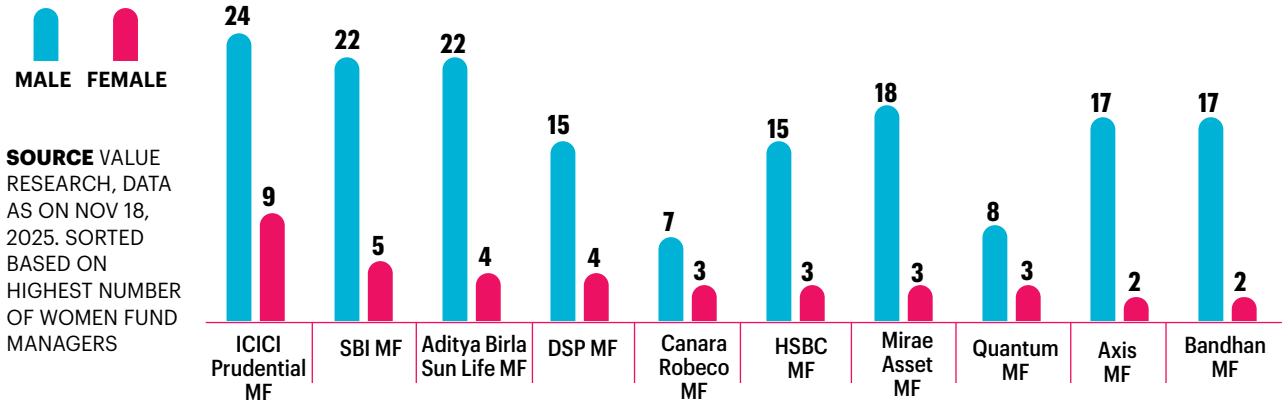
Some of the largest MFs have women leading from the front



● NET ASSETS (₹CR) ● 1-YEAR RETURN (%) ● FUND MANAGERS- ○ MEN ● WOMEN
SOURCE VALURESEARCHONLINE.COM; DATA AS ON OCT 31, 2025

Gender Balance Across AMCs

90 |



SOURCE VALUE RESEARCH, DATA AS ON NOV 18, 2025. SORTED BASED ON HIGHEST NUMBER OF WOMEN FUND MANAGERS

and research environments dominated by men, and built credibility in equity research when women analysts were often denied access to company management.

The shift towards entrepreneurship began as an act of defiance. When the Bombay Stock Exchange opened 71 new memberships in 1992, she was advised not to apply. "This is a brokers' club. They'll never give it to a non-Gujarati, non-Marwari, let alone a woman," she was told, as Mehra remembers. She ignored the advice and secured Membership Holder No. 69: a moment that changed her trajectory.

Through the 1990s she built First Global into one of India's most respected research-driven brokerages. The firm expanded abroad, becoming the first Asian (ex-Japan) member of the London Stock Exchange in 1999 and later obtaining a US broker-dealer licence.

Today, she reflects on gender dynamics with clarity and bluntness. "Don't clip your own wings. Embrace ambition. Be a bit pushier than comfortable," she says. Mehra also highlights a familiar frustration: women being dismissed or interrupted in meetings. "Let me finish," she says, describing her current response to such situations.